

Q I have a Pentium III 1.0 GHz, a Vesta 810e Intel chipset board with 256 MB of SDRAM and an 80 GB Seagate HDD running Win98 and WinXP as the OSes, a CD-ROM and an LG CD-RW. I also have a 40 GB Seagate HDD not connected to the system. The 40 GB HDD is divided into three partitions running Win98. The 80 GB HDD is divided into six partitions—four as FAT and two as NTFS. How do I connect my HDD to my system without opening the cabinet? Do I need any special drivers?

Ravi Shah

A It is possible to convert an internal HDD to an external HDD. You need to buy a case which retails for Rs 1,500-2,000. Just put your drive in the case and connect it to your PC with a USB cable. These cases do not support SATA drives—only regular IDE ATA disk drives.

Q I want to set up Wi-Fi at work with a single desktop and my Wi-Fi-enabled laptop. Can I use a wireless PCI card and communicate directly with my laptop with the RF waves from both terminals? Does technology support such configuration? Or is an AP a must? Can I use only an AP connected to the desktop that will communicate with the laptop? Which brand is preferred for the hardware (AP, wireless PCI card)?

Dedhia

A You do not need an access point to setup a wireless network between your laptop and your desktop. You need to set up an Ad Hoc access point. First, install the wireless card on your desktop. If you are using Windows XP, your card will be automatically detected and the drivers will install. If other networks are available, Windows will automatically open the window for wireless network connection. If not, click the 'Wireless Connections' icon to open the window.

If applicable, clear all connections in preferred access points to make sure that you connect only to your laptop. On the top right of your window, click the 'Advanced' tab and select 'Computer to Computer (Ad Hoc) networks only.' Un-click the 'Automatically